tea, I talked to the tea board officials and recommended that they should open a chapter in Arunachal Pradesh as they had no presence till then. It didn't surprise me when I learnt that even the Darjeeling variety of tea could be produced in Arunachal Pradesh. Consequently, we have made good progress in this field. Moreover, I have been telling the state's farmers to grow the organic variety of tea because of the high returns it would give.

Arunachal has the longest stretch of Himalayan mountain chain (about 1000 kilometers) in the country. In fact, other than Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh, no other state in the northeast has the Himalayas. Therefore, all-out efforts to create a mountaineering institute in Arunachal Pradesh were being made by the state government. For this we needed the sponsorship and financial backing of the ministry of defence and accordingly, I was constantly in touch with the minister. Eventually, on the state's twenty-fifth statehood day on 20 February 2012, the defence minister, A.K. Antony, announced the sanction of this project by the Government of India.